



Learning Space

IAS MAINS 2020

ETHICS, INTEGRITY & APTITUDE

CASE STUDIES

MODULE - 3

CASE STUDY - 3

A fifty-year old man was suddenly struck with high fever, and he was taken to a private hospital in the nearby city. The hospital is known for values and ethics, and rising up to the occasion whenever humanitarian concerns arise. Doctors admitted the patient without any pre-payment. Later on, he was diagnosed with a rare viral disease, which was highly infectious, and the area holding him was quarantined. For seven days, none of his relatives had access to him. He was about to be discharged the next day and doctors had done the best possible to cure the rare disease. But, the patient's condition unexpectedly took a turn for the worse and he died due to multiple organ failure during the wee hours on the day of his proposed discharge.

However, the relatives of the patient who could not fathom the rigorous restrictions on visiting the patient were suspicious about the motive of the hospital. Due to the pre-conceived suspicion, the relatives turned rebellious instantly and attacked the hospital, doctors and nurses. They were of the belief that the patient had been dead for several days but was still kept in the hospital just to extract money from them. This quickly became a law and order problem as several citizens of the city, believing this narrative, supported the relatives.

In such inflammatory circumstances, what will be your response as the Municipal Commissioner of the city? Examine the qualities of a public servant which will be required to manage the situation. (250 words)

This case clearly reflects the recent narratives of civilians assaulting doctors and doctors stopping their services in protest.

ETHICAL ISSUES INVOLVED

➤ Medical ethics (patient service as first priority – Hippocratic oath)

VS

➤ Working conditions and security of self.

➤ Protecting doctors

VS

➤ Controlling misinformed public

➤ Law and order

VS

➤ Other patients' care

CASE STUDIES

As the municipal commissioner of the city, I will respond as follows

- Immediately setup a committee to inspect the procedure followed in hospital.
 - ↳ Assure the relatives and people of strict punishment to hospital in case of misdoings.
- Assure the doctors about providing them security.
 - ↳ Ask them to quickly start their services to other patients.
- Station some police personnel at the hospital premises till law and order is brought under control.
- Put the findings of committee transparently open to public and explain them clearly.
- Conduct awareness campaigns in colleges, offices & colonies to not resort to or condone violence.
 - ↳ Provide them with possible legal solutions if they are betrayed by the hospital.

CONCLUSION

Trust on doctors and service motive towards patients are necessary in healthy doctor-patient relation. Misdoings of any kind can disrupt this relation and adversely affect society.

QUALITIES OF A PUBLIC SERVANT TO CONTROL THE SITUATION

- **EMOTIONAL INTELLIGENCE**
Ability to understand the emotions and feelings of both sides before taking decisions.
- **RATIONALITY**
Analyze a situation based on facts and logic rather than being influenced by emotions of misinformed public.
- **EMPATHY**
Understanding the emotions and feeling the pain of aggrieved relatives before taking action on them.
- **SOCIAL SKILLS**
Ability to properly articulate and persuade both doctors and relatives to bring normalcy.
- **UPRIGHTNESS**
Should not exploit the situation to blackmail doctors for money. It affects efficiency and ethics of doctors.

WE EXPRESS OUR
SINCERE THANKS
FOR VIEWING THIS VIDEO

Presented by



Learning Space

For Suggestions:

suggestions@learningspace.in

To Contact us:

info@learningspace.in

For Information:

info.learningspacedigital@gmail.com

Visit us at:

www.learningspacedigital.com

0866 244 44 72

98499 42299

94415 27588